Mashhad *madrasa* (1165–1176 CE). These observations are meant to underscore what may be obvious, *viz*. that the historical frontiers of Ghur were porous and even seasonal, requiring an expansive and flexible understanding of it and its contiguous regions.

23. A. A. Kohzad 1954a: 23. See also O'Neal 2016a. As of the nineteenth century, historical Ghur could be conceived as encompassing the areas of transhumance and/or nomadic pastoralism of the Firozkohi and Taimani populations (see *infra* in main text and notes): the Firozkohis' ambit extended from Bala Murghab (modern Badghis Province) to the Hari Rud's northern banks; and the Taimanis' from the Hari Rud as far as Girishk, near Lashkari Bazar. Cf. esp. Maitland 1888: 605–608.
24. While A. A. Kohzad's (cf. esp. 1951a, 1954a, 1954b) extensive reports on the settlement of Ahangaran and the larger region are extremely valuable, I am deeply grateful to Jawan Shir Rasikh (pers. comm., December 2017) for sharing not only his photographs of the site and its vicinity, but also his enlightening observations. See also Ball 2019: No. 15.
25. See esp. A. A. Kohzad 1954b: 13: though the ensuing description is of populations farther south in the Yakhan Valley (discussed below), the author made the useful distinction between "migrant" (i.e., transhumant) and "nomadic" populations: the nomads traditionally traveled much farther in seeking seasonally hospitable climates, while their "migrant"/transhumant counterparts moved only from built dwellings to collapsible ones such as yurts, largely within the same area (e.g. Figure 2.12). Numerous parallels are also forthcoming from Turkic nomadic populations, such as the Khazars (tenth century), and the contemporaneous Oghüz (Golden 2013: 50–51, 54).
26. A. A. Kohzad 1953: 57ff.; also Barfield 1981: 97ff. for added data from northeastern pastoral nomads, who "are tied far more closely to the market economy than are many … farmers."
27. Gascoigne's (2010: 145) analysis of ceramic finds from Jam-Firuzkuh left open the possibility that, based on comparative material from Marv (Turkmenistan), some unglazed coarse wares from the site might be datable even prior to the eleventh century, thus before the earliest dates on Jam-Firuzkuh's Judeo-Persian tombstones. Cf. also *infra* in main text and notes.
28. Cf. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 364 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 385–386); Thomas 2018: 149. Admittedly, the notion that the Shansabanis' summer rather than winter settlement evolved into a "capital"-like locale creates a contrast to the sedentizing tendencies of most other transhumant and nomadic pastoralist groups, whose winter encampments or settlements usually constituted their initial *foci* of consolidated political power and the formation of ruling elites. Cf. Golden 2013: 22, 30, 59.
29. This circuit of movement was possibly the residue of an *il-rah*, a collective term referring to the prescribed routes of seasonal transhumance traceable to the Shansabanis' *more* transhumant lifestyle prior to the mid-twelfth century. Taken from the fieldwork of Barth (1961: 4–5) among the Basseri confederacy of tribes in southern Iran, the term *il-rah* encapsulates the affective concept of "tribal road": The *il-rah* in fact varied among the major nomadic groupings of the region, each having their own traditional route of seasonal migration.